

The Long Way Around

a novel

Sample Author

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ONE

The Letter

*“Not all those who wander are lost.” — an epigraph, for
example*

The letter arrived on a Tuesday, which Mara would later decide was exactly the kind of day a letter like that should arrive -- ordinary enough that she almost didn't notice the return address until she was halfway through slitting the envelope open with a butter knife.

She read it twice standing at the kitchen counter, then a third time sitting down, because some sentences only make sense once you've stopped expecting the floor to hold still under you.

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The letter arrived on a Tuesday, which Mara would later decide was exactly the kind of day a letter like that should arrive -- ordinary enough that she almost didn't notice the return address until she was halfway through slitting the envelope open with a butter knife.

TWO

The Platform

By the time the train pulled out of the station, she had rehearsed the conversation four different ways and liked none of them.

She read it twice standing at the kitchen counter, then a third time sitting down, because some sentences only make sense once you've stopped expecting the floor to hold still under you.

About the Author

[Placeholder -- author bio goes here.]